

INSIDER FRUIT TRADING

Version: 0.108

Buy low; sell high!

Welcome to the cutthroat wholesale farmers market where buying and selling fruit changes its price. Because an inside tip about bananas becoming scarce, you stocked piled bananas. When they surge in price you now sell them for a juicy profit. With a hand full of Insider Information, see if you can make more money than anyone else.

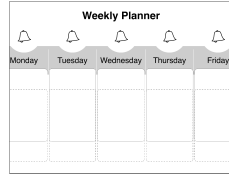
Have you ever experienced surge pricing? Explore how to maximize profits from supply swings as they affect prices in this miniature commodities market. How do traders make money when they know prices will tank?

Objective

Make the most money.

Use supply-side inside information to buy low and sell high.

Components

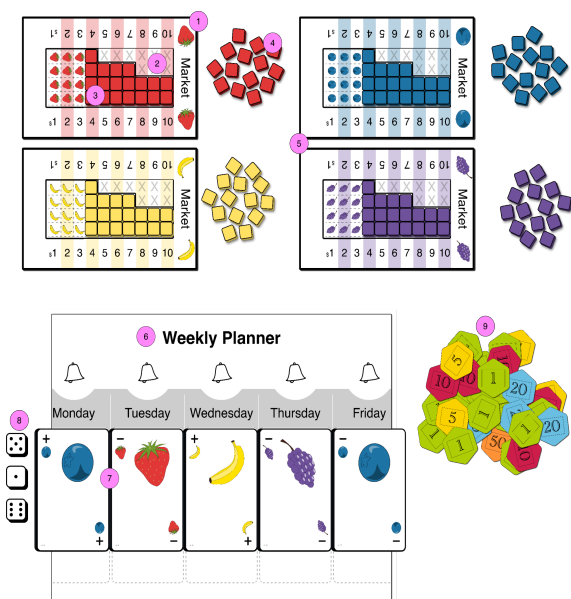
 4 Fruit Markets for the fruit cubes to fill up 40 strawberry fruit cubes 40 banana fruit cubes 40 blueberry fruit cubes 40 grape fruit cubes  24 Double Fruit Insider Information cards for players to keep hidden	 4 Multiplier Insider Information cards for players to make big moves  20 Single Fruit Insider Information cards that all players get to see at the beginning of the week  1 Weekly planner board for the Single Fruit timeline	 11 turn order tokens; including a First Player token  4 Player aids  3 dice  A pile of money
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Game Setup

Setup cards

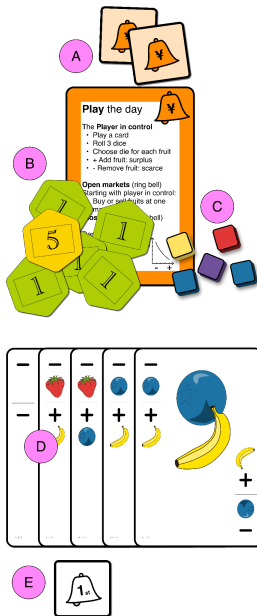
	Separate the Insider Information cards 1. Shuffle the 20 Single Fruit cards into one deck. 2. Shuffle the 24 Double Fruit cards into another deck. 3. Separate 5 Multiplier cards into a 3rd deck.
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Setup Markets



1. Place the strawberry market in the middle of the table with the #10 on the bottom right.
2. For your first game, use the side of the markets with the X marks inside the market.
3. Cover the strawberry icons inside the well from columns 4-10; leave columns 1-3 empty.
4. Place the remaining strawberry cubes to the side. Optional: use a cup
5. Repeat steps 1-5 for banana, blueberry, and grape.
6. Place the Weekly Planner next to the markets.
7. Deal the deck of Single Fruit cards face down onto the 5 days of the week. 1 card per play for each day.
 - o Flip over the top card of each day.
8. Place the dice near the Monday side of the Weekly Planner.
9. Place the money in a pile in the middle of the table to form a bank.

Setup Players



Give each player:

- A. Player aid card and 2 bell tokens matching the player's color
- B. \$10 (any denominations)
- C. 5 fruit cubes
 - 1 random fruit [each player should have a different fruit]
 - 1 of each type of fruit [1 strawberry, 1 blueberry, 1 grape and 1 banana]
- D. 5 Insider Information cards (keep secret)
 - 1 Multiplier (++) Insider Information card
 - 4 Double Fruit Insider Information cards from the shuffled deck of Double Fruit cards.
- E. Give the player who ate fruit most recently the First Player token.

Discard the remaining decks of Double and Single Fruit Insider Information cards in the box. They won't be used anymore.

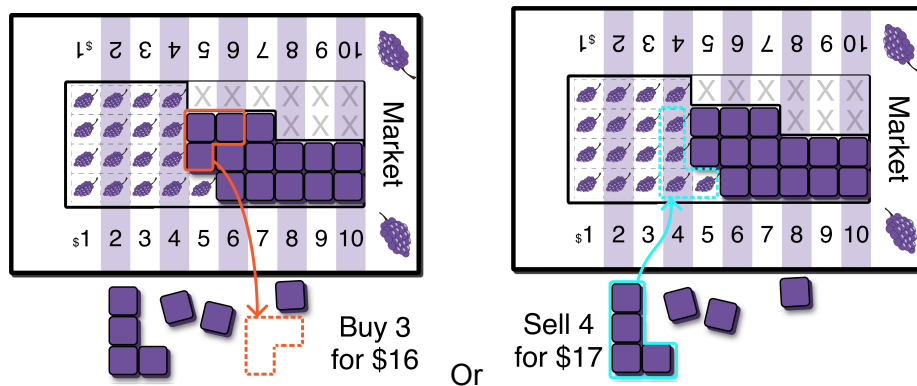
Core concepts

Insider Fruit Trading centers around four central fruit markets in which prices are driven by the supply of that fruit. When adding to the market, fill up the most expensive columns first. When removing, take from the cheapest columns first.

Buy or sell at a market

As players buy fruit, prices get higher; when they sell fruit, prices get cheaper. While you may sell (or buy) as many fruit cubes as you want, each cube is priced separately. So if you bought more than 4 at a time, you will be paying more for some of them.

A grape example



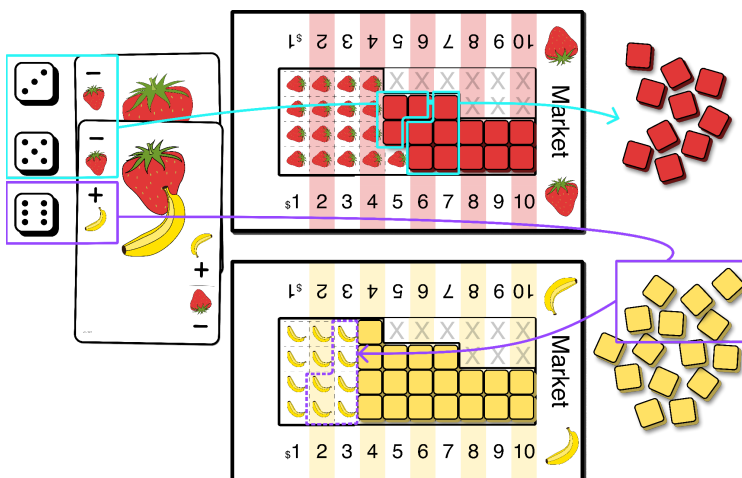
When presented with this grape market, you have the option to buy more fruit or sell the ones that you already have. If you bought 3 grapes, the first 2 would cost you \$5 each, but the third would cost \$6 for a total of \$16. If you sold 4 grapes, the first would sell for \$5, but the rest would sell for \$4 for a total profit of \$17.

Hand of Insider Information

Your hand cards will only be Double Fruit (and 1 Multiplier) Insider Information cards. They represent the secret material non-public information that only you know. Your fruit holdings and cash are public. Your entire hand of cards gets played as market manipulations by the end of the game. When you manipulate the market, you always play a Double Fruit (or Multiplier) card on top of an existing Single Fruit card and roll 3 dice.

Playing a Double Fruit Insider Information card

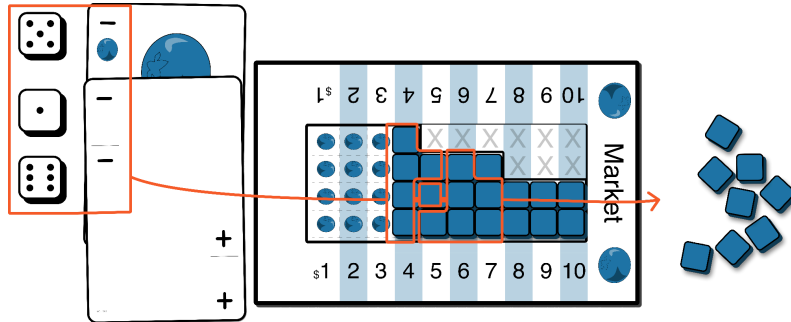
When you play a “- strawberry + banana” Double Fruit card on top of an existing “- strawberry” Single Fruit card, you remove strawberries and add bananas from the markets. Roll the dice to see how many get moved. You choose which die gets applied to which fruit. Each fruit gets one die.



For example: You rolled a 5, 3 and 6. Then you placed the 3 with the “-” strawberry, which would cause 3 strawberries to be removed from its market. Next you placed the 5 with the other “-” strawberry, which would cause 5 more strawberries to be removed from its market. A total of 8 strawberries are removed. The last die, the 6 gets placed with the “+” bananas, which would cause 6 bananas to get added to its market.

Playing the multiplier ++ / --

The multiplier card is also in your hand of Insider Information and is played on top of a single fruit card. The Single Fruit card's fruit is the only market affected. Declare if it is the ++ or the -- side of the card before you roll. Roll all 3 dice. Apply each die to one + or - symbol on the left of the two stacked cards. All 3 dice are applied to the Single Fruit card's market.



- In the above example, the player would apply each die to a - symbol, resulting in removing a total of 12 blueberries from the market.
- **No other market is affected.**

Supply and Demand

Insider Information tells you about the changing supply of fruit.

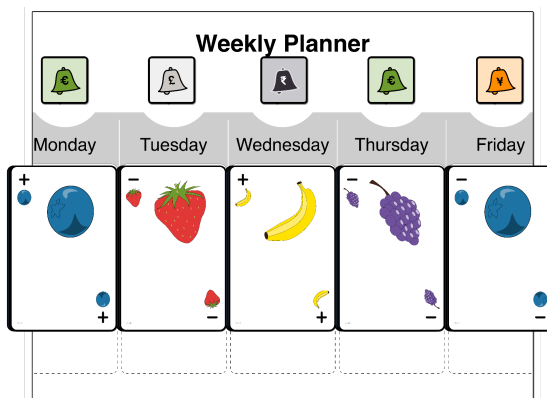
- “-” removes from the market supply, creating a **shortage**
 - After you play it, that fruit will **buy / sell** for **more**.
- “+” adds fruit to the market supply, creating a **surplus**
 - After you play it, that fruit will **buy / sell** for **less**.

Play

Overview

The game is played across 3-4 weeks with a different player choosing first each week. For each week, there are two phases: plan and play. To plan, players take turns choosing days to control until all days have been reserved. Then players play each day, one day at a time, manipulating the market then buying or selling fruit.

Plan the week



Starting with the player with the First Player token:

- Reserve a day to control
 - Place your colored bell above that day on the bell outline.
 - Draw the top face down card of the day that you chose. It is under the face up card. You will be putting it back on that day at the end of this week.
 - The player to your left selects an unclaimed day to control.
 - Continue until everyone has reserved a day.
- If there are still unreserved days, players select them in reverse order starting with the last player.

Play the day

The image illustrates the 'Weekly Planner' and 'Market Manipulation' mechanics of a game.

Weekly Planner: A grid showing the days of the week (Monday to Friday) and the currency used each day (Euro, Pound, Rupee, Dollar, Yen). Below the planner are five cards representing different fruits: Strawberry, Banana, Grape, and Blueberry. Each card has a direction (+ or -) and a fruit icon. The cards are labeled with letters A, B, and C, indicating specific actions.

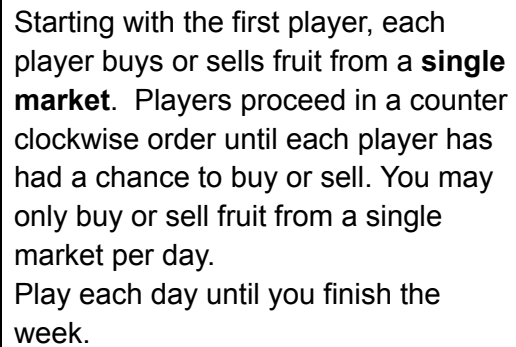
Market Manipulation: Two diagrams show how to manipulate the market. The left diagram shows a 'Market' board with a grid of numbers (1-10) and a 'Market' label. A red box highlights the 'Market' board, and a red arrow points from the 'Market' board to a pile of blue cubes (representing blueberries). The right diagram shows a 'Market' board with a grid of numbers (1-10) and a 'Market' label. A purple box highlights the 'Market' board, and a purple arrow points from the 'Market' board to a pile of yellow cubes (representing bananas).

Manipulate the market

1. Starting on Monday, find the player in control. They will manipulate the markets.
2. The player places an Insider Information card from their hand on top of the Single Fruit card on the day they control. (Do not cover the Single Fruit card's direction and fruit symbols in the upper left corner.)
3. Roll all 3 dice.
 - Choose which die to apply to each fruit.
 - + Add or - remove the amount of fruit cubes by the number shown on the die from that fruit's market.

In this example, the green player places the 4 and 5 die on + blueberry actions (see A, B) and 2 die on - bananas (see C). 9 blueberries are added to the blueberry market. This reduces the price of blueberries to \$1. It also removes 1 banana which would allow you to sell bananas at a higher price.

Everyone gets to buy or sell. Ring the bell.



- Discard the used Insider Information.
- Place the Single Fruit Insider Information card that you drew at the beginning of the week back onto the day of the week that you controlled. (your bell should be there)

4. Return all bells to their players.

- Pass the First Player token to the left. That person will start off planning the new week.

The game ends after everyone has taken a turn as the first player. By the end, everyone runs out of Insider Information. Those that have extra fruit can sell them using Friday's turn order.

The player with the most money at the end of the game wins.
In the event of a tie, share the fruits of your labor.

Exotic fruit instruments

After you play the core game and successfully buy low and sell high, you can try some more advanced financial instruments, short selling and options.

Borrowing fruit: (Short selling)

Market boundaries

To get the full short selling experience we need to expand the boundaries of the marketplace.

Always a \$1 fruit

There are always \$1 fruit slots available. If a market is completely full and can not fit any more fruit, place the fruit below the \$1 column next to the market and treat all of them like \$1 fruit. Players will need to buy or remove these before the \$2 fruit can be purchased or removed. Place the general fruit supply beyond the \$10 fruit side to not confuse these \$1 fruit with the general supply.

+\$10 token market

If you run out of fruit within a market you can use the +\$10 token to indicate prices in this market are actually +10 more.

When you are remove the last fruit at the lower prices:

- Take note of how many more fruit cubes you want to remove.
- Place the +\$10 token on that market.
- Fill in the market with fruit cubes from the fruit bank from \$20 all the way to \$11.
- Proceed to remove the noted fruit cubes from earlier.
- Prices start at \$11 now at the low end.

When you are about to add more fruit cubes than can fit in the \$11 - \$20 range:

- Take note of how many more fruit cubes you want to add.
- Remove the +\$10 token from that market
- Remove all fruit cubes from the market into the fruit bank
- Proceed to add the noted fruit cubes from earlier.
- Prices at the high end are at \$10 now.

You can use the fruit blockers to constrain quantities differently than in the lower tier fruit.

If you are playing with a fruit blocker, decide before starting the game which shape you are using. AKA will you move/rotate the fruit blocker when switching to the +\$10 market.

Short selling

Warning: Try this after you have understood the basic game. The main strategy of the game is to “buy low; sell high.” Short selling introduces the possibility of “Sell high; (then) buy low”

When the markets are open, and it is your turn to buy or sell, you may borrow fruit to sell it at its current market price by borrowing it from the bank. You have to return it by the end of the game.

Borrow fruit

- Take a fruit cube from fruit bank (the pile next to the market)
- Take a matching loan token. The loan tokens have a square hole punched out that the fruit should fit inside.
- You must take a loan token for each fruit you borrow.
- Normal selling rules still apply:
 - a. Sell the borrowed fruit cube at market prices by placing it in the market and taking the money it sold for.
 - b. The more you sell the less valuable they become.
 - c. You can only interact with one market at a time. This means you can do this at the same time as you sell any existing regular fruit cubes already in your possession. Then borrow some more and sell those.

Costs

- Each loan costs \$1 per week. It is paid at the end of each week, on the end of day Friday.

Return fruit

- Normal buying rules still apply:
 - a. Pay market prices for each fruit that you buy.
- Take a fruit cube that you own and a loan token and return them both as a pair to the fruit bank. Feel free to use the square hole punched out of the loan token to match each fruit cube with their loan tokens before returning them.
- You have to return all borrowed fruit by the end of the game.
 - a. On the last Friday of the game, after the market closes, everyone who has any loans outstanding must buy fruit to return them. This is the only time you're allowed to have negative cash. This may mean buying some expensive fruit, especially if another player has short squeezed you.
 - b. After all loans are resolved, anyone holding fruit will get to sell their fruit.
 - c. Use Friday's turn order at the end of the game to determine buying order.
- You can return borrowed fruit earlier if you want.

Missions: Stock options

Deal out 2-3 from a deck of options cards at the beginning of the game. They can be exercised at any time in the game. There would be 2 kinds.

- Option to buy:
 - A specific fruit would be named on the card
 - A specific price would also be listed (probably \$3)
 - A specific quantity would be listed (probably 3)
 - This would allow the player to buy fruit and pay the card's value and not use the market value.
- Option to sell:
 - A specific fruit would be named on the card

- A specific price would also be listed (probably \$7 or \$8)
- A specific quantity would be listed (probably 3)
- This would allow the player to sell fruit and get paid the card's value and not use the market value.

Extra slices

Fruit blockers

Shape the supply curve by positioning different fruit blockers before the start of the game. Fruit blockers change the number of fruit that fit per price point in the market. For your first time using the Fruit Blockers, the staircase shaped blocker described in the setup instructions is recommended. Remove the fruit cubes from the markets and place the fruit blocker with its thicker part on the \$10 as seen below. This results in 2 fruit slots available at \$10-8 each, 3 fruit slots available at \$7-5 each and 4 fruit slots available at \$1-4. Fill in fruit cubes up to and including \$4 fruit.

Sum and Cumulation chart

For the staircase configuration there is a trick we can use with sums and cumulative sums to make the math a bit easier. Use this chart to make those computations.

Price per fruit	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Fruit per column	4	4	4	4	3	3	3	2	2	2
\$ Sum per column	4	8	12	16	15	18	21	16	18	20
\$ Cumulative sums	4	12	24	40	55	73	94	110	128	148

- If you need to buy or sell a whole column of fruit: use the “sum per column” values.
- If you are buying or selling from more than one column: use the “Cumulative sums” values:
 - Subtract the value found in the highest price column you are buying/selling from from 1 column below the lowest price column that you are buying/selling from.
 - For examples:
 - If I wanted to buy all the full column fruit priced from 4-7, then subtract 94 from 24; the 13 fruit would cost \$70.
 - If I wanted to sell all the full column fruit priced from 9-5, then subtract 128 from 40; the 13 fruit would make \$88

x4 fruit tokens

If you run out of fruit use these x4 fruit tokens. The best place to use them is in the markets. This makes the cubes available for players to buy and sell, as well as add and remove during manipulation.